1 **gold** [gəʊld] *n.* — золото
A yellow metal. It is very expensive.
→ My grandmother has a gold ring.

2 **thief** [θi:f] *n.* — вор
A person who takes things that are not his.
→ Close the window! There is a thief in the garden.

3 **steal** [sti:l] *v.* — красть, воровать
To take a thing that is not yours.
→ Please don't steal my pen!

4 **tent** [tent] *n.* — палатка
A small house made of cloth. You sleep in it outside.
→ We are sleeping in a tent near the river.

5 **dark** [dɑ:k] *adj.* — тёмный
There is no light.
→ The room is dark and I can't see my bag.

6 **clean** [kli:n] *adj.* — чистый
Not dirty.
→ I wash my hands, and now they are clean.

7 **donkey** ['dɒŋki] *n.* — осёл
A small grey animal with long ears. It helps people carry things.
→ The donkey is eating grass in the field.

8 **tail** [teɪl] *n.* — хвост
The long part at the back of an animal.
→ Look at my cat's tail! It is very long.

9 **pot** [pɒt] *n.* — кастрюля, котелок
You cook food in it, on the fire.
→ The pot is black, because it is always on the fire.

10 **cook** [kʊk] *n.* — повар
A person who makes the food.
→ Our cook is making soup now.

Useful phrases from the story

one by one — по одному
The children are going into the class one by one.

keep a secret — хранить секрет
I know his name, but I keep the secret.

The Donkey That Knows the Thief

1



Rustam is a rich man. He has a big bag of **gold**. Tonight he is sleeping in a house on the road.

In the morning the **gold** is not there.

Rustam is very angry. He is looking at Karim. Karim is a poor boy. He works in this house. He washes the **pots** every day.

“You are the **thief**!” Rustam says. “The **gold** is in your pocket!”

“No,” Karim says. “I am not a **thief**. Tonight the **thief** shows himself.”

2



Now it is night. There is a small **tent** in the yard. A **donkey** is standing inside it.

“This **donkey** is magic,” Karim says. “You go in, **one by one**. In the **dark** you put your hand on his **tail**. The **donkey** knows the **thief**. He cries out.”

The men are going into the **tent**, **one by one**. They are coming out again.

But the **donkey** is quiet. He is eating his grass.

3



“Your magic does not work,” Rustam says.

“Show me your hands,” Karim says. “All of you.”

Nine men have black hands. One man has **clean** hands. He is the **cook**.

“He does not touch the **donkey**,” Karim says. “He is afraid. The **tail** is black tonight, because I put the black **pot** on it.”

Now the **cook** is looking at his **clean** hands. He is telling Rustam about the **gold**.

Every day the **donkey** eats his grass. He knows nothing about **gold** or **thieves**. But he **keeps a secret** very well.